‘investigation’, the ministry dropped seven charges, and decided to conduct an ‘oral inquiry’ into the first two charges. These were, one, forcibly taking custody of the accused from the Kerala Police; and two, torturing at least three of the accused. Nothing came out of the ‘oral inquiry’. Sreekumar went on to become DGP, Intelligence, Gujarat.

I was still exploring options to unravel the conspiracy behind the ISRO spy case when M K Dhar’s book *Open Secrets: India’s Intelligence Unveiled* was published in 2005. Once I read the book I realised there was no point in meeting this man who knew more than me about the conspiracy against India, but continued to be loyal to his foreign masters by clinging on to the theory of espionage.

I found Dhar’s book a big bundle of 519 pages, to be precise, of self-righteousness, lies and bravado. In an attempt to give his arguments a façade of credibility, Dhar makes a suggestion. A joint investigation agency should be formed with representatives from the IB, CBI, R&AW and the ISRO to have a detailed look into the evidences and documents for arriving at a final conclusion. There is no harm if this reinvestigation is carried out silently and out of the glare of the media.

Dhar did not live to see such an investigation. He died in May 2012. Now, his suggestion is my demand. A joint investigation of all the top agencies should expose the real conspiracy and its infantrymen. I will strive to make it happen.

Till then, Mr Dhar, RIP.